Rubric Design Guidelines

1. Binary and Objective

Each rubric criterion must be strictly binary: it should be clearly assessable as either met or not met.
- Avoid wording that requires interpretation, judgment, or reasoning.
- Focus only on observable evidence in the response.
- Do not evaluate why something is stated—only whether it is stated.

Example:

❌ Not binary: “Explains why exercise increases life expectancy”

✅ Binary: “Mentions that exercise increases life expectancy”

When testing reasoning:

- Mentions that exercise increases metabolism
- States that exercise improves heart health
- Affirms that exercise contributes to longer life expectancy

Do not include a summarizing or inferential step.

2. Self-Contained

Each rubric item must be fully understandable and assessable on its own.
- The grader evaluates one criterion at a time.
- Do not reference other criteria.
- Use clear, domain-appropriate language.
- Define specialized terms if needed.

3. Unstacked (Atomic)

Each rubric item must evaluate only one requirement.
- Avoid combining multiple checks into a single criterion.
- Avoid “and”, “or”, or conditional constructions.

Example:

❌ “Mentions that the determinant of A is -2 and the trace of A is 5”

✅ “Mentions that the determinant of A is -2”

✅ “Mentions that the trace of A is 5”

4. Directly Grounded in the Prompt

Every rubric item must have a 1:1 relationship with what is explicitly requested in the prompt.
- Do not evaluate anything that was not asked.
- Avoid implicit expectations.

5. Timeless and Stable

Rubric items must remain valid regardless of time or context changes.
- Avoid references to current events or temporary conditions.

6. Measurable Through Explicit Signals

Each criterion should be verifiable through clear signals in the response.
- Look for explicit statements or direct mentions.
- Avoid tone or intent-based evaluation.

7. Weighted by Importance (Scoring Guidance)

Each rubric item should have an assigned weight reflecting its importance.
- More critical requirements → higher weight.
- Relative weighting matters more than absolute values.

Summary Checklist

- Binary
- Objective
- Self-contained
- Atomic
- Prompt-aligned
- Timeless
- Measurable